

NIMRA SHAHID

Rawalpindi/Attock, Pakistan | nimrashahidk3@gmail.com | +92 341 9829932 | LinkedIn: Nimra Shahid | GitHub: NimraShahid54

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Cybersecurity graduate (BS, Air University, 2026) with hands-on experience across penetration testing, web application security, SIEM analysis (IBM QRadar), vulnerability assessment, and cloud security (AWS). Currently working as a QA Analyst & Security Researcher, combining functional QA testing with authorized penetration testing on a live production platform. Builds practical AI-security skills through projects such as an XGBoost-based phishing detection system (96.4% accuracy on ~750K URLs) and LLM prompt-injection testing. Seeking a full-time cybersecurity, penetration testing, or SOC analyst role where I can apply offensive and defensive security skills to protect real systems.

CORE SKILLS

Security Testing: Penetration Testing · Web Application Security (OWASP Top 10) · Vulnerability Assessment & Remediation · API Security Testing

SIEM / Monitoring: IBM QRadar · Incident Response · Malware Analysis · Digital Forensics (Volatility, Autopsy, FTK Imager)

Tools: Burp Suite · Metasploit · Nmap · Nikto · SQLmap · OWASP ZAP · Acunetix · Vega · Wireshark · Kali Linux · PentAGI

Cloud & AI: AWS (IAM, KMS, CloudTrail, CloudWatch, Config, Lambda) · Applied ML for Security (XGBoost) · LLM/Prompt-Injection Testing

Programming: Python · C++ · Bash · HTML/CSS

Frameworks & Compliance: NIST 800-53 · ISO 27001 · GDPR · Risk Management · Access Control (IAM)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

QA Analyst & Security Researcher

Mar 2026 – Present

Music & Entertainment Streaming Platform (Freelance Contractor) | Florida, USA (Remote)

- Perform authorized penetration testing and security research on a live production web platform, identifying vulnerabilities such as session hijacking risks, deprecated TLS 1.0/1.1 protocols, SWEET32/3DES cipher weaknesses, CSP misconfigurations, and missing security headers.
- Author formal vulnerability assessment reports (via Python/ReportLab) detailing findings, risk severity, and remediation guidance for the development team.
- Lead functional QA testing across staging and production environments using BrowserStack and Burp Suite, producing structured bug reports and severity-coded UX audits.
- Built a prompt-injection testing lab to evaluate the security of the platform's AI chatbot, identifying manipulation risks in LLM-driven customer interactions.
- Collaborate directly with developers and founders to prioritize and verify fixes, closing the loop between security findings and shipped code.

Red Team Cybersecurity Intern

Jul 2025 – Present

Confidential Organization | Islamabad, Pakistan (On-Site)

- Perform penetration testing on a CTF-style platform, identifying and exploiting real-world web application vulnerabilities.
- Use Acunetix and Vega vulnerability scanners to identify, document, and validate security findings.
- Execute offensive security simulations covering reconnaissance, exploitation, and post-exploitation phases of real-world attack chains.

Cyber Defense and Networking Intern

Aug 2024 – Nov 2024

ThincsCorp | Remote

- Researched and compared enterprise firewall technologies across client environments including finance, e-commerce, and healthcare sectors.
- Built a comprehensive Risk Register mapping cybersecurity risks to controls and mitigation strategies, aligned to ISO 27001.
- Deployed and configured IBM QRadar SIEM (Community Edition), integrated security agents, and authored full installation documentation.
- Built QRadar dashboards to monitor security event logs and flag anomalies for investigation.
- Conducted malware analysis in an isolated sandbox VM, documenting behavior patterns, IOCs, and mitigation recommendations.

Cyber Security Intern

Feb 2024 – Mar 2024

- Engineered a suite of cybersecurity tools in C++ and Python, including a keylogger, password complexity checker, packet capture tool, and image manipulation tool.
- Optimized core algorithms for the packet capture tool and keylogger, improving performance and reliability.
- Designed a GUI for the image manipulation tool in Python, improving overall usability.

PROJECTS

SafeLink SecureVault — AI-Powered Phishing Detection System 2025 – 2026

Final Year Project — Team Lead | Kamra, Pakistan

- Built an XGBoost-based phishing URL classifier trained on ~750,000 URLs, achieving 96.4% detection accuracy.
- Developed a Chrome extension with Gmail integration, a LinUCB contextual-bandit adaptive layer, and five parallel detection engines for real-time link scanning.
- Built a sandboxed browser environment and a React dashboard backed by a FastAPI backend for analyst review and reporting.
- Presented the system at FYP Expo 2026 and briefed industry contacts on its architecture and detection approach.

Cryptographic Key Management System Jun – Jul 2024

Academic Project — Team Lead | Kamra, Pakistan

- Built a full-featured key management system with CLI and GUI interfaces supporting symmetric key generation, encryption/decryption, authentication, and key lifecycle management.

AWS Cloud Security Foundation Labs Sep – Nov 2024

Amazon Web Services | Online

- Secured AWS resources using IAM policies, security groups, and KMS encryption, achieving 81.74% lab accuracy.
- Monitored security incidents via CloudTrail and CloudWatch, and automated remediation workflows with AWS Config and Lambda.

TryHackMe Cybersecurity Labs Jan 2024 – Present

Ongoing Independent Skill Development | Remote

- Web Application Security: SQLi, XSS, and authentication bypass using Burp Suite, SQLmap, and OWASP ZAP.
- Digital Forensics: Memory dump and disk image analysis with Volatility, Autopsy, and FTK Imager.
- Network Security: OpenVAS scanning, firewall/IDS/VPN configuration, and Wireshark traffic analysis.
- Offensive Security: Metasploit exploitation, privilege escalation, and exploit chaining (SMB, vsftpd, Samba).
- Governance & Compliance: Applied GDPR, ISO 27001, and NIST 800-53 principles in policy and risk exercises.

EDUCATION

B.S. in Cyber Security Expected Sep 2026

Air University | Kamra, Pakistan

- Concentration: Network Security & Cyber Defense
- Relevant Coursework: Security Operations & Monitoring · Access Control & IAM · Vulnerability Assessment & Management · Incident Response Fundamentals · Secure Software Development · Digital Forensics · Cryptography · Cloud Computing Security

ACTIVITIES & LEADERSHIP

Air University Tech Ambassador — Engaged 500+ students in technology-focused initiatives, fostering innovation and professional development across campus. (Ongoing)

Digital Pakistan Cybersecurity Hackathon — Participated in a national-level hackathon focused on practical threat detection and defense. (2024)

CosmiCode Coding Competition — Certificate of Appreciation for outstanding performance. (2024)